



An estimated 40,000–50,000 people died in Paris in 1590 until the Spanish army led by the Duke of Parma broke the four-month siege in September.

BY 1590, **TOYOTOMI HIDEYOSHI** (see 1582–87) had effectively completed the **unification of Japan**, and the distinctive character of the regime that was to dominate the country for over 250 years was established. Though it was not the capital, from 1590 Hideyoshi based himself at **Edo**, where the feudal nobility, now entirely subservient to him, were required to spend every other year. It proved a highly effective means of preventing rebellion. This elaborate social structure was largely supported by the peasantry, who had to pay heavy taxes.

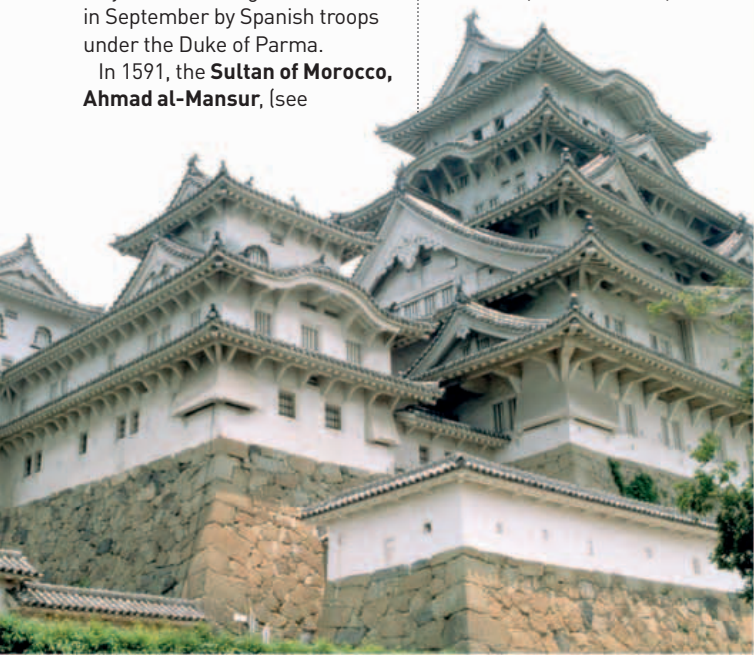
Attempting to impose himself on France as king, **Henry of Navarre** (see 1588–89) **besieged Paris** in May 1590. The siege was broken in September by Spanish troops under the Duke of Parma.

In 1591, the **Sultan of Morocco**, **Ahmad al-Mansur**, (see

1578–79), launched an invasion of the troubled **Songhay Empire** (see 1582–85). Al-Mansur's goal was the **trans-Saharan gold trade**. The invasion involved a perilous four-month crossing of the Sahara by a fighting force of 4,000 men sustained by 8,000 camels. In March 1592, a Songhay army over 40,000 strong was routed at the **Battle of Tondibi** by the Moroccans' vastly superior firepower, which included numerous arquebuses and eight English cannons.

Castle complex

Himeji, or "White Egret," Castle is one of 200 massive castles built on the orders of Toyotomi Hideyoshi to ensure his power across Japan.



£500,000

THE GREATEST PRIZE EVER TAKEN BY ENGLISH PRIVATEERS, FROM THE MADRE DE DEUS



Rialto Bridge

The Rialto Bridge over the Grand Canal in Venice was completed in 1592. It was the fifth bridge built at the site, and the first made of stone.

THE SEVEN YEAR WAR began in the spring of 1592 when **Japanese forces** mounted a sustained **invasion of Korea**. Partly an attempt by Toyotomi Hideyoshi to unite the Japanese in a common cause, it was more particularly the fulfillment of his predecessor Oda Nobunaga's ambitious goal of a **conquest of Ming China** itself. The campaign met with mixed results. Japanese land victories in Korea were matched by Korean naval victories—the heavily armed and protected Korean turtle ships proving decisive against Japan's progressively weakened fleets. **Chinese intervention** late in the year tipped the balance against Japan. By the spring of 1593, the Japanese were forced to sue for peace. By the middle of the year, they had begun to pull out. In 1597, the aging Hideyoshi renewed the campaign, sending larger forces. The result was a **further defeat for Japan** in 1598, but the savage fighting **devastated Korea**. Though the war did not formally

end until 1608, by 1599 it was effectively over. Paradoxically, it was Japan that benefited most. The defeat had a significant influence on its subsequent, if never absolute, isolation from the wider world. Korea, by contrast, took years to recover, while the immense cost of the war to Ming China not only provoked riots against the extra taxes levied but weakened its military capacity on its vulnerable northeastern frontier. From 1592, **Akbar** (see 1555–56) launched a further round of conquests that saw the **Mughal Empire's frontiers** reach their greatest extent during his reign. In the east, Orissa was annexed. In 1594, Baluchistan and the coastal strip of Makran on the Safavid Persian border were conquered. And in 1596, the **key Afghan city of Kandahar**, lost by Akbar's father Humayan, was retaken.



In this Portuguese map of Mombasa, Fort Jesus is depicted bottom right.

THE OTTOMAN-HABSBURG FRONTIER

generally stable after the renewed Ottoman attempt on Vienna in 1529, was a key focus of Ottoman-Christian conflict. It came center-stage again in 1593 with the **Long War**. A series of inconclusive campaigns followed in Hungary and the Balkans, with the nominal Ottoman vassals of Transylvania, Wallachia, and Moldavia supporting the Habsburgs. The net result of the eventual peace settlement—the **Treaty of Zsitvatorok** of 1606—was to leave the frontier in a state of simmering uncertainty.

On June 10, 1594, in the Spanish settlement of St. Augustine, Florida, Father Diego Escobar de Zambrana baptized Maria, daughter of Juan Jimenez de la Cueva and Maria Melendez. The event was recorded in the oldest public document in what would become the US and is the first authentic record of a **child born to European settlers** there.

Fort Jesus in Mombasa, East Africa was built at the command of Philip II and completed in 1593. It proved to be crucial to Portuguese endeavors in the Indian Ocean throughout the 17th century.

“ PARIS IS WORTH A MASS. ”

Henry IV of France, 1593

August 18, 1590 English Virginia Colony at **Roanoke** found abandoned

1590 Publication of *Arcadia* by English poet Philip Sidney (1554–88)

May 21, 1590 Ottoman frontiers extended to Caucasus and Caspian following **Ottoman-Safavid peace treaty**

September 1590 Duke of Parma ends Henry of Navarre's siege of Paris

1590 Toyotomi Hideyoshi (c. 1536/37–98) completes unification of Japan

1591 Moroccans capture Timbuktu, Songhay Empire

1591 Regent of Russia **Boris Godunov**, suspected of murdering nine-year-old son of Ivan the Terrible

May 23 Japanese invasion of Korea begins **Seven Year War** (to 1598)

August English privateers capture Portuguese galleon **Madre de Deus**

1593 English privateers capture Portuguese galleon **Madre de Deus**

Moroccans take Songhay capital **Gao**

Completion of the **Rialto Bridge**, Venice

Mughals annex **Orissa**, India

July 25, 1593 Henry of Navarre converts to Catholicism

1593 Japanese pull out of Korea after Chinese military intervention

1593 Portuguese complete **Fort Jesus**, Mombasa

1593 Long War between Habsburgs and Ottomans (to 1606)

February 27, 1594 Coronation of Henry IV of France